



Pelvic Pressure During Pregnancy

Understanding & Managing a Common Pregnancy Symptom

Very Common

Especially in the 2nd & 3rd trimesters

Usually Normal

Not typically a sign of a problem

Manageable

Simple measures can provide relief

? WHY AM I FEELING PELVIC PRESSURE?

COMMON CAUSES

- › Normal **downward pressure** from the growing uterus and baby
- › Baby's position pressing on the **cervix or pelvic floor**
- › Increased blood flow and **softening of pelvic tissues**
- › Stretching of **ligaments** that support the uterus
- › Prior vaginal delivery — you may notice pressure earlier in subsequent pregnancies

i Pressure alone is usually normal, especially if you are not having contractions, bleeding, or fluid leakage. If you have had a prior vaginal delivery or perineal tear, you may be more aware of pelvic sensations.

🛌 REST, SUPPORT & EXERCISES

REST & POSITIONING

- › **Tip** Lie on your side (**left side preferred**)
- › **Tip** Avoid prolonged standing
- › **Tip** Elevate hips slightly with a pillow when resting
- › **Tip** Avoid heavy lifting

PELVIC SUPPORT

- › **Rec** Consider a **maternity support belt**
- › **Rec** Wear supportive, low-heeled shoes
- › **Rec** Avoid sudden twisting or uneven weight-bearing

PELVIC FLOOR EXERCISES (KEGELS)

- › Tighten muscles you would use to **stop urine flow**
- › Hold **5 seconds** , relax 5 seconds — repeat **10 times, 3x daily**
- › Avoid tightening abdomen, thighs, or buttocks

i Kegels help strengthen the pelvic floor and may reduce pressure symptoms.

🏃 ACTIVITY, HYDRATION & WELLNESS

ACTIVITY MODIFICATION

- › Take **frequent breaks** at work
- › Sit when possible
- › Avoid high-impact exercise
- › **Good** Swimming or **prenatal yoga** can be helpful

HYDRATION & BOWEL CARE

- › Drink **adequate fluids** throughout the day
- › Avoid constipation — use fiber, fruits, vegetables
- › Straining **increases pelvic pressure**

PHYSICAL THERAPY REFERRAL

- › If symptoms become **pelvic floor** bothersome, **physical therapy** can provide guided strengthening and support techniques

i Ask your provider about a referral if home exercises are not providing enough relief.

📞 WHEN TO CALL THE OFFICE

🚨 Call Immediately If You Experience:

- › **Regular contractions**
- › **Vaginal bleeding**
- › **Leakage of fluid**
- › **Decreased fetal movement**
- › **Severe or worsening pelvic pain**
- › A feeling of something **"bulging"** from the vagina

✅ Reassurance:

- › Pelvic pressure is **very common** and usually normal
- › It does not typically indicate preterm labor
- › Most women find relief with **simple measures**
- › Your provider will monitor you at each visit

REMEMBER

- › Continue attending your **routine prenatal visits**
- › If symptoms worsen or you are concerned, **please call the office**
- › Every pregnancy is different — trust your instincts

Pelvic pressure is a very common and usually normal part of pregnancy. Simple strategies like rest, pelvic support, Kegel exercises, and activity modification can make a real difference. Your care team is here to support you through every step of your pregnancy — if you have any questions or concerns, don't hesitate to reach out. **Call us: (281) 557-0300**